DIGITAL LITERACY

Project Report

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Introduction

This project was completed as part of the Digital Literacy course, where I took on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. The aim of this project was to understand how to effectively use digital tools, build a professional online presence, and promote safe and responsible behavior in the digital world.

Through this project, I worked on multiple tasks such as creating a digital literacy infographic, building my online portfolio on platforms like GitHub, Kaggle, and Stack Overflow, exploring coding platforms like HackerRank, and understanding professional communication through email writing. I also researched cybercrime and learned how to stay safe online.

Overall, this project helped me understand that digital literacy is not just about using technology, but about using it smartly, safely, and responsibly in both academic and real-life situations.

Task 1

I used Canva to create my digital literacy infographic because it is easy to use and has many ready-made templates, icons, and design options. It helped me arrange my ideas neatly without needing advanced design skills, and I could experiment with colors and layouts quickly.

My infographic explains what digital literacy means in a simple way. It shows that digital literacy is not just about using technology, but also about understanding and communicating information effectively. I also included some useful digital tools for students like Google Docs, Khan Academy, and Zoom, along with how they can help in studying and learning. In the last section, I focused on safe internet practices such as using strong passwords, being careful while sharing personal information, and verifying sources before trusting them.

One thing I found a bit difficult was deciding how much information to include without making the infographic look too crowded. At the same time, it was interesting to choose icons and colors for each section, as it made the design more attractive and easier to understand.

Task 2

For my digital portfolio, I chose Kaggle, GitHub, and Stack Overflow because they are some of the most useful platforms for students in tech. Each one serves a different purpose, which makes them important in their own way.

Kaggle is mainly used for data science and machine learning. It allows users to work with real datasets, try out projects, and even participate in competitions. GitHub is where I can store and manage my code, and it's especially useful for showcasing my projects and tracking my progress over time. Stack Overflow, on the other hand, is a platform where programmers ask and answer questions, so it's really helpful when I get stuck or want to learn something new.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms more actively. I want to regularly upload my projects on GitHub, practice and take part in competitions on Kaggle, and use Stack Overflow not just to ask questions but also to answer them as I improve. This way, I can keep learning, build a strong portfolio, and create a good online presence for my future career.

Task 3

For this task, I used HackerRank, which is a platform designed to help people improve their coding skills through practice problems. It offers challenges in different programming languages and topics, so it's a good place to start for beginners and gradually move to more advanced problems.

I created my account and solved my first Python introductory challenge, which was printing "Hello, World!". Even though it was a very basic problem, it helped me understand how the platform works—like writing code, running it, and submitting it. It felt like a small step, but it made me more comfortable with the process.

Platforms like HackerRank can be really helpful academically because they encourage regular practice. Coding is something you improve by doing, not just reading, and this kind of platform makes that easier. It also helps in developing problem-solving skills and logical thinking, which are important for exams and technical subjects. If I keep practicing regularly, it will definitely make coding easier for me and also help in the future for internships and placements.

Task 4

Social Media Checklist:

Do's:

- Think before you post: Make sure your content is appropriate and won't harm your reputation.
- Use privacy settings: Control who can see your posts and personal information.
- Verify information: Check facts before sharing anything to avoid spreading misinformation.
- Be respectful: Communicate politely and avoid arguments or offensive language.
- Use it productively: Follow educational pages, join communities, and learn new skills.

Dont's:

- Don't share personal details: Avoid posting your address, phone number, or sensitive info.
- Don't engage in cyberbullying: Never post hurtful or harmful comments about others.
- Don't overshare: Posting everything about your life can affect privacy and safety.
- Don't believe everything online: Not all content is true or reliable.
- Don't waste excessive time: Avoid scrolling for hours and neglecting studies or responsibilities.

Case Study:

A famous example of how poor **digital communication** can cause serious problems is the Mars Climate Orbiter loss. This mission, led by NASA, was supposed to study Mars' atmosphere. However, there was a major issue in digital communication between the teams working on it. One team used metric units, while another used imperial units, and this difference was not properly communicated or checked through their systems.

Because of this small but critical mistake in digital communication, the spacecraft entered Mars' atmosphere at the wrong angle and was destroyed, leading to a loss of about $125 million.

This example shows that even a small gap in digital communication can have huge consequences. If the teams had clearly documented their work, used a standard system, and cross-checked their data, the problem could have been avoided. It highlights how important clear and accurate digital communication is, especially in large and complex projects.

Task 5

What surprised me the most while researching this topic was how simple most cyber scams actually are. I always thought hacking required advanced skills, but many scams just rely on people making small mistakes—like clicking a link in a hurry or not checking a payment request properly. It was also surprising to see how common these scams are, especially among students who use UPI regularly without thinking twice.

One habit I will definitely change is being more careful before taking any action online. Earlier, I would sometimes click on links or approve requests without really thinking, especially if I was in a hurry. Now, I plan to slow down and double-check everything, especially when it involves money or personal information. Even a few extra seconds of caution can prevent a big problem.

Conclusion

Overall, this project was a useful learning experience that helped me become more aware of the digital world and how to navigate it effectively. I learned how to present myself professionally online, communicate properly through emails, and use platforms that can support my academic growth.

The tasks also made me more conscious about online safety and the importance of being careful while using digital tools, especially in financial transactions. This project was not just theoretical but practical, as it involved creating real profiles and resources that I can continue to use in the future.

It has helped me build a strong foundation for my digital presence moving forward.

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